The Last Strongholds – Three Act Story Structure

Act I – The Mountain Stronghold

The Mountain Stronghold was the first place struck by the catastrophe.

Once a towering gothic Stronghold built into the mountainside, its halls now lie shattered and abandoned.
The obelisk at its center still glows, but the scholars who once protected it are gone.

You are a young acolyte who survived the disaster.

With most of the scholars dead, you must take up the task they once carried.
Corrupted creatures begin attacking the Stronghold, drawn to the power of the obelisk.

Using your arcane training, you learn to channel magic through your hands and rebuild ancient defensive constructs left behind by the Stronghold.
Arcane turrets, crystal clusters, and forgotten magical defenses are brought back to life.

As the waves of enemies grow stronger, you fight to hold the Stronghold and defend the obelisk.

At the end of the assault you confront the Fallen Sentinel, a once-loyal guardian of the Stronghold now twisted by corruption.

Defeating it secures the first stronghold, but the war has only begun.

Act II – The Underground Stronghold

Seeking answers, you travel to the second Stronghold hidden deep beneath the earth.

This Stronghold once studied the deeper nature of arcane power. Massive caverns filled with glowing crystals
and ancient arcane machinery reveal the truth behind the catastrophe.

Here you discover what truly happened.

The Fallen Sorcerer did not simply unleash corruption, he bonded with it.
The arcane energy that should have destroyed him instead transformed him into something far more powerful.

Now sustained by unstable magic, he commands the corrupted creatures attacking the stronghold.

His goal is clear: seize the obelisks and control the flow of magic across the world.

As you battle deeper into the underground ruins, the enemies become stronger and more dangerous.

At the heart of the Stronghold you face the Obelisk Devourer, a monstrous creature feeding on the arcane power
of the underground obelisk.

Defeating it protects the second stronghold, but the Fallen Sorcerer is already moving toward the final Stronghold.

Act III – The Coastal Stronghold

The final Stronghold stands on a cliff overlooking a violent sea.

This coastal Stronghold became the last refuge for the surviving scholars after the catastrophe began.
Here they attempted to make their final stand.

But even this stronghold could not stop the corruption.

Now the Fallen Sorcerer prepares his final assault.

Wave after wave of corrupted creatures march toward the final obelisk as storms rage across the cliffs.

Using everything you have learned across the academies, you rebuild the last defensive structures
and prepare for the final battle.

At the height of the assault, the Fallen Sorcerer himself appears.

Seeking to claim the obelisk and control the flow of magic forever, he confronts the last defender standing.

In the final battle you defeat the Fallen Sorcerer and sever his connection to the corrupted arcane energy.

With his defeat, the corruption begins to fade and the three obelisks stabilize once more.

You are no longer simply an acolyte.

You have become the first Arcane Guardian of the strongholds.